

REASON, REVELATION AND FAITH

THREE-TERM CONTROL → FOUR RELATION MODELS → REVELATION TYPES AND TESTS → AQUINAS AND NATURAL THEOLOGY → KIERKEGAARD, FIDEISM AND FAITH → SCIENCE, MIRACLE AND TESTIMONY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

THREE-TERM CONTROL

THREE-TERM CONTROL PUBLICLY ASSESSABLE INFERENCE, COHERENCE AND EVIDENCE CLAIMED DIVINE SELF-DISCLOSURE THROUGH EVENT, PERSON, TEXT OR EXPERIENCE TRUSTING COMMITMENT WITH COGNITIVE, VOLITIONAL AND PRACTICAL DIMENSIONS REASON

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

REASON: publicly assessable inference, coherence and evidence
REVELATION: claimed divine self-disclosure through event, person, text or experience

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

FAITH: trusting commitment with cognitive, volitional and practical dimensions reason tests interpretation
revelation supplies content faith appropriates a
it is not merely low-evidence assent.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

REASON: publicly assessable inference, coherence and evidence
REVELATION: claimed divine self-disclosure through event, person, text or experience

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Reason tests warrant, revelation claims divine disclosure, and faith adds trusting commitment beyond conclusive demonstration.

01

STAGE 01

FOUR RELATION MODELS

FOUR RELATION MODELS REASON AND FAITH ONE DEFEATS THE OTHER (STRONG RATIONALISM) DISTINCT DOMAINS OR LANGUAGE-GAMES MUTUAL QUESTIONS, ANALOGIES AND CORRECTION ONE COHERENT ACCOUNT; NATURAL AND REVEALED THEOLOGY COOPERATE EXAM RULE

IDENTIFY WHICH REASON, WHICH FAITH AND WHICH CLAIM

REASON AND FAITH

CONFLICT: one defeats the other (strong rationalism / fideism)
INDEPENDENCE: distinct domains or language-games
DIALOGUE: mutual questions, analogies and correction

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

REASON AND FAITH
CONFLICT: one defeats the other (strong rationalism / fideism)
INDEPENDENCE: distinct domains or language-games

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

DIALOGUE: mutual questions, analogies and correction
INTEGRATION: one coherent account; natural and revealed theology cooperate
EXAM RULE: identify which reason, which faith and which claim

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

scientific mechanism, metaphysical ground and salvific meaning need not compete directly.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The crucial question is not reason versus faith in the abstract, but which reason assesses which religious claim and with what authority.

02

STAGE 02

REVELATION TYPES AND TESTS

REVELATION TYPES AND TESTS CREATION, CONSCIENCE, UNIVERSAL REASON HISTORICAL ACT, PROPHET, INCARNATION, SCRIPTURE TRUTHS COMMUNICATED GOD DISCLOSED IN ENCOUNTER/HISTORY AUTHENTICATION TESTS INTERNAL COHERENCE MORAL FRUITS HISTORICAL CREDIBILITY

GENERAL / NATURAL: creation, conscience, universal reason

SPECIAL: historical act, prophet, incarnation, scripture
PROPOSITIONAL: truths communicated
PERSONAL/EVENT: God disclosed in encounter/history

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

GENERAL / NATURAL: creation, conscience, universal reason
SPECIAL: historical act, prophet, incarnation, scripture
PROPOSITIONAL: truths communicated

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

PERSONAL/EVENT: God disclosed in encounter/history
AUTHENTICATION TESTS internal coherence
moral fruits

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

historical credibility
communal continuity fit with prior knowledge
capacity to disclose rather than merely confirm desire circularity problem: scripture authenticates God while God authenticates scripture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Revelation claims disclosure unavailable to unaided reason and therefore requires independent tests of authenticity, coherence and moral credibility.

03

STAGE 03

AQUINAS AND NATURAL THEOLOGY

AQUINAS AND NATURAL THEOLOGY ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES TRUTHS ACCESSIBLE TO REASON THAT GOD EXISTS, SOME ATTRIBUTES, NATURAL LAW MYSTERIES ABOVE TRINITY, INCARNATION; NOT CONTRARY TO REASON GRACE PERFECTS NATURE IMPORTED METAPHYSICS MAY DOMESTICATE REVELATION REPLY

REASON DOES NOT GENERATE MYSTERY; IT REMOVES CONTRADICTION AND

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES truths accessible to reason: that God exists, some attributes, natural law mysteries above reason: Trinity, Incarnation
not contrary to reason grace perfects nature

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

revelation guides reason where inquiry is difficult or salvation urgent contradiction cannot be genuinely divine because truth cannot
it removes contradiction and clarifies implication.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES truths accessible to reason: that God exists, some attributes, natural law mysteries above reason: Trinity, Incarnation
not contrary to reason grace perfects nature

MECHANISM / VERDICT — ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES truths accessible to reason: that God exists, some attributes, natural law mysteries above reason: Trinity, Incarnation; not contrary to reason grace perfects nature; revelation guides reason where inquiry is difficult or salvation urgent contradiction cannot be genuinely divine because truth cannot conflict with truth objection: imported metaphysics may domesticate revelation reply: reason does not generate mystery; it removes contradiction and clarifies implication.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aquinas allows reason to establish preambles of faith while revelation supplies mysteries that exceed, but should not contradict, reason.

04

STAGE 04

KIERKEGAARD, FIDEISM AND FAITH

KIERKEGAARD, FIDEISM AND FAITH OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY + INFINITE PERSONAL CONCERN SUBJECTIVE APPROPRIATION FAITH IS PASSIONATE COMMITMENT, NOT A THEOREM FORCED BY ABRAHAM EXPOSES THE "TELEOLOGICAL SUSPENSION OF THE ETHICAL" PROBLEM PROPOSITIONAL ASSENT

TRUST AND ALLEGIANCE FAITH MAY EXCEED AVAILABLE PROOF WITHOUT LEAP LICENSES FANATICISM

OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY + INFINITE PERSONAL CONCERN → SUBJECTIVE APPROPRIATION

Kierkegaard: faith is passionate commitment, not a theorem forced by detached proof
Abraham exposes the "teleological suspension of the ethical" problem belief-that: propositional assent
belief-in: trust and allegiance faith may exceed available proof without affirming contradiction objection: leap licenses

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY + INFINITE PERSONAL CONCERN → SUBJECTIVE APPROPRIATION
Kierkegaard: faith is passionate commitment, not a theorem forced by detached proof

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

Abraham exposes the "teleological suspension of the ethical" problem belief-that: propositional assent
belief-in: trust and allegiance faith may exceed available proof without affirming contradiction objection: leap licenses fanaticism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

reply: authentic faith entails inward risk, responsibility and transformation, not arbitrary immunity from criticism.
OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY + INFINITE PERSONAL CONCERN → SUBJECTIVE APPROPRIATION

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kierkegaard locates faith in committed inwardness under objective uncertainty, not in arbitrary belief without reasons.

05

STAGE 05

SCIENCE, MIRACLE AND TESTIMONY

SCIENCE, MIRACLE AND TESTIMONY SCIENCE ASKS REPEATABLE NATURAL MECHANISM; RELIGION MAY ASK GROUND HUME ON MIRACLES PROPORTION BELIEF TO EVIDENCE; FALSE TESTIMONY IS USUALLY MORE ASSESS SPECIFIC EVENT, INDEPENDENT WITNESSES, BACKGROUND PROBABILITY AND DIVINE

TESTIMONY IS INDISPENSABLE BUT DEFEASIBLE; MIRACLE CANNOT BE INFERRED

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism
religion may ask ground, value and destiny conflict arises when sacred interpretation makes empirical claims or scientism makes total claims

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

HUME ON MIRACLES: proportion belief to evidence; false testimony is usually more probable than violation of uniform experience
REPLIES: assess specific event, independent witnesses, background probability and divine context

EVALUATION / TRAP

TESTIMONY is indispensable but defeasible; miracle cannot be inferred merely from anomaly.
SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism
religion may ask ground, value and destiny conflict arises when sacred interpretation makes empirical claims or scientism makes total claims

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EVALUATION / TRAP

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SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Scientific and religious claims may differ in scope, but miracle and testimony claims still enter ordinary evidential assessment.

06

STAGE 06

JUSTIFICATION AND INDIAN PARITY

JUSTIFICATION AND INDIAN PARITY BELIEF SHOULD MATCH PUBLICLY AVAILABLE EVIDENCE REFORMED EPISTEMOLOGY BELIEF IN GOD MAY BE PROPERLY BASIC UNLESS DEFEATED WITTGENSTEINIAN VIEW FAITH HAS GRAMMAR WITHIN A FORM OF LIFE INDIAN PARITY ŚRUTI/ŚABDA AS TESTIMONY

YUKTI AS REASONING

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

EVIDENTIALISM: belief should match publicly available evidence
REFORMED EPISTEMOLOGY: belief in God may be properly basic unless defeated
WITTGENSTEINIAN VIEW: faith has grammar within a form of life
INDIAN PARITY śruti/śabda as testimony

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

yukti as reasoning
anubhava as realisation
Advaita: scripture initiates inquiry; reasoning removes contradiction
knowledge culminates in direct realisation

EVALUATION / TRAP

Nyāya: āpta testimony is a pramāṇa but must be semantically and causally trustworthy
Mīmāṃsā: authorless Veda avoids dependence on a divine speaker.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

EVIDENTIALISM: belief should match publicly available evidence
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EVALUATION / TRAP

Nyāya: āpta testimony is a pramāṇa but must be semantically and causally trustworthy
Mīmāṃsā: authorless Veda avoids dependence on a divine speaker.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religious belief may be inferentially warranted, properly basic or testimony-based, yet every model remains open to defeaters.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS DEFINE ALL THREE TERMS SELECT CONFLICT/INDEPENDENCE/DIALOGUE/INTEGRATION MODEL DISTINGUISH REVELATION TYPE NAMED THINKER STRONGEST OBJECTION AND REPLY INDIAN ŚRUTI-YUKTI-ANUBHAVA COMPARISON

PRACTICAL AND PUBLIC IMPLICATIONS AVOID "FAITH VERSUS REASON" AS

DEFINE all three terms → select conflict/independence/dialogue/integration model

distinguish revelation type → named thinker → strongest objection and reply

Indian śruti-yukti-anubhava comparison → practical and public implications avoid "faith versus reason" as a slogan

is contrary, above or supported by reason

QUALIFIED VERDICT: faith needs neither reduction to proof nor exemption from criticism

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

DEFINE all three terms → select conflict/independence/dialogue/integration model
distinguish revelation type → named thinker → strongest objection and reply

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

Indian śruti-yukti-anubhava comparison → practical and public implications avoid "faith versus reason" as a slogan: ask whether faith
is contrary, above or supported by reason

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

QUALIFIED VERDICT: faith needs neither reduction to proof nor exemption from criticism
rationally responsible faith is interpretive trust answerable to coherence, evidence and moral fruit.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Faith should be neither reduced to proof nor protected from criticism; it is responsible commitment under incomplete evidence.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] DOCTRINE STATEMENT, REASON CAN INFER AND TEST SOME RELIGIOUS IT IDENTIFIES PUBLICLY ACCESSIBLE PREMISES, DERIVES IMPLICATIONS, TESTS COHERENCE PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

REALITY IS INTELLIGIBLE AND REASON IS NOT WHOLLY CORRUPTED NATURAL THEOLOGY DIFFERS FROM PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION THE FORMER ARGUES TOWARD THEOLOGICAL CONCLUSIONS

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
Doctrine statement. Reason can infer and test some religious claims without relying on a special historical disclosure.
Argument.
It identifies publicly accessible premises, derives implications, tests coherence, and distinguishes demonstration, probability and practical postulation.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

Presupposition. CAUTION: Reality is intelligible and reason is not wholly corrupted or confined to empirical objects.
Distinction.
Natural theology differs from philosophy of religion: the former argues toward theological conclusions
the latter also analyses language, experience and warrant.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

Canonical examples. Aquinas' preambles of faith; Nyāya inference to Īśvara.
Objection → reply.
CAUTION: Kant restricts speculative reason beyond possible experience.
Natural theologians reply that metaphysical inference concerns conditions of experience, not another observed object.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.